



PlayStation VR

Sony announces new VR headset for PS5, expects to launch next year.
<http://digit.in/mar21-65>



TikTok Pays Out

TikTok has agreed to pay \$92m to settle a lawsuit accusing it to misuse user information.
<http://digit.in/mar21-66>

Poco M3

Stylish and functional

The Poco M3 is the successor to the popular M2. Equipped with a 6,000mAh battery, stereo speakers, and a spanking FHD+ display, the Poco M3 sounds like a solid offering on paper for under 15K. Let's find out how it performs in our review.

Build and design

The Poco M3 is one of the best looking phones within this price range. The phone's textured back panel looks gorgeous. The textured back also keeps fingerprints at bay and makes it easier to grip the phone. Weighing 198g, the phone is slightly bulky. There's a power button that also doubles as a fingerprint scanner which was pretty responsive and speedy. You get a dual stereo speaker setup with the Poco M3 which is excellent for this price point. Inside the box, you get a basic silicone case for the phone.

Performance

The Poco M3 is powered by the Qualcomm Snapdragon 662 SoC. After performing our usual benchmarking tests, we saw that the Poco M3's performance, at least when it comes to benchmarks, is slightly underwhelming. The device scored lower than both the Realme Narzo 20 and Redmi 9 Power in AnTuTu 8.0, albeit the 9 Power beat it by a hair's breadth. In real-world usage though, the Poco M3 rarely falters for its price. The phone accomplishes multitasking well and stutters and lag are few and far in between. For gaming, we played Call of Duty: Mobile and the phone defaulted to High graphics and Medium frame rate. Under these settings, we recorded an average FPS of 48 with 74 per cent stability on Gamebench. If you drop the graphics down to medium from high, the numbers jump up to 51 fps with 94 per cent stability. The phone did get warm during our COD sessions though. Moving on to software, the



Poco M3 comes with MIUI 12 on top of Android 10 with the Poco launcher. While it is similar to MIUI on Xiaomi devices, the Poco M3 is supposed to be free of ads. We did not encounter any ads during our usage. What was present, however, was bloatware. The M3 comes with preinstalled apps including GetApps, Netflix, LinkedIn, Facebook, some Mi apps, and a few games. Thankfully, most of these apps can be uninstalled.

Display

The Poco M3 is one of the few smartphones at approximately the 10K price point to sport a Full HD+ display. The Poco M3 comes with a 6.53-inch IPS LCD display with Corning Gorilla Glass 3 for protection. The display on the Poco M3 is one of the better ones at this price range with vibrant colours and decent viewing angles. The display is bright for indoors usage rated at 400 nits of peak brightness. Although, we measured the peak brightness to go up to 212 nits. The phone also comes with WideVine L1 support, so you can stream HD content on OTT platforms.

Battery life

The Poco M3 comes packing a massive 6,000mAh battery that supports 18W

Fast Charging. The Poco M3's battery life is more than enough to even last heavy users approximately over a day. The phone comes with a 22.5W charging adapter, although the phone tops out at 18W Fast Charging. In our tests, half an hour of streaming Netflix content in HD dropped the battery by 6 per cent and an hour of GPS navigation took it down by another 6 per cent.

Camera

The Poco M3 comes with a triple rear camera setup consisting of a 48MP primary lens, a 2MP macro camera, and a 2MP depth camera. There's a glaring omission, which is an ultrawide lens that is available in competitors such as the Realme Narzo 20 and

Redmi 9 Power. For selfies, you get an 8MP shooter. Daylight photos taken from the main

camera turned out pretty well. The dynamic range was passable for the most part. Portrait shots had pretty decent edge detection. Selfies taken on the 8MP camera are average.

Moving on to the low light

performance, the primary rear camera performs mediocrity in low light. There is plenty of noise and the phone struggles to lock focus. Night mode makes low light imaging slightly better.

Verdict

The Poco M3 is more than just its premium looks. It offers much more for an affordable price point including excellent battery life, decent performance, 6GB RAM, a crisp FHD+ display, and a stereo speaker setup.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

CPU: Qualcomm Snapdragon 662 | GPU: Qualcomm Adreno 610 | RAM: 6GB | STORAGE: UFS 2.1 64GB / UFS 2.2 128GB, expandable up to 512GB via microSD card | REAR CAMERAS: 48MP + 2MP + 2MP | SELFIE CAMERA: 8MP | DISPLAY SIZE: 6.53-inch | DISPLAY TYPE: IPS LCD | DISPLAY RESOLUTION: Full HD+ (2340x1080) | OS: Android 10, MIUI 12 | BATTERY: 6000mAh with 18W Fast Charging | DUAL SIM: Yes

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